

William "Chase" Culbertson

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Computer engineering student who spent two years running production LLM infrastructure on bare metal: an on-prem inference platform serving 600+ users, with multi-model routing, fine-tuned models, tool integrations, and usage analytics.

EDUCATION

B.S., Computer Engineering · Purdue University · Purdue Presidential Scholarship Fall 2026 to 2030
High School Diploma · Lakeside School, Seattle, WA · ACT 34 Graduated May 2026

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Backend Lead · Project Andromeda Jun 2024 to Jun 2026
Lakeside School, Seattle, WA

- On-prem LLM inference platform, now serving 600+ users across the school.
- Made the technical case for buying GPUs over subscriptions and got a **\$12,000 hardware budget** approved by the Head of School. The commercial subscription path priced out near **\$600K/year**.
 - Built the backend: multi-model routing, per-user authentication, usage analytics, and tool integrations including WolframAlpha and citation lookup.
 - Ran a phased rollout that doubled the user base every three weeks under capacity monitoring, from 25 pilot accounts to full Upper School availability.
 - Fine-tuned models against specific course rubrics, including an essay-feedback model built with an English teacher and piloted in her sections.
 - Migrated the platform off OpenWebUI onto a custom React/Node stack after hitting limits in RAG quality and per-group model permissions.

Researcher · Google TPU Research Cloud 2025 to Present
Remote

- Training a diffusion language model on granted TPU capacity, based on Google DeepMind's DiffusionGemma.

Co-Founder & Lead Model Developer · SculptorAI 2023 to Present
Remote · Open-source AI research group

- Trained and released the **Ursa** model family on HuggingFace.
- Lead developer on **aiportal**, the multi-model chat platform now serving Andromeda. MIT licensed, ~470 commits. github.com/Sculptor-AI/aiportal

Co-Founder & Technical Director · Xenon Hosting 2019 to Present
Remote

- Built the full stack for a game-server hosting company: custom control panel, automated provisioning, billing, and client management.
- Currently converting the company into a nonprofit that provides compute grants.

Infrastructure Intern · Lakeside School Technology Dept. Summers 2022 to 2025
Seattle, WA

- Campus device deployment and network printer infrastructure, plus the early groundwork for the school's AI access program.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure Linux, Docker, on-prem GPU servers, networking, vLLM, Ollama, TPU/XLA
ML PyTorch, JAX, HuggingFace Transformers, fine-tuning, distillation, RAG, evaluation
Software Python, Swift, JavaScript/Node, React, C++, Java, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Git

HACKATHONS & OTHER

COMMA HACK 7, comma.ai, San Diego, CA, Sep 2026. Participant.
Eagle Scout with three palms, Boy Scouts of America. Eagle project delivered technology-literacy and scam-awareness training for older adults.
Guitar, 8 years. Conversational Spanish.

PRESS

"The Andromeda Project." *Lakeside Magazine*, Spring/Summer 2025. Feature, pp. 20-21.
"A Follow-Up on Andromeda AI." *Tatler*, 2025.
"AI Enters the Classroom: Grotto Interns Pioneer Lakeside's First AI." *Tatler*, 2024.